



Contacting customers for product swaps.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how Customer Success contacts customers when a product on their order is out of stock and a replacement is required. The objective is to keep the order active, swap the missing item for an in-stock alternative, and ship the same day without creating unnecessary accounting work.

2. Scope

Applies to all Customer Success agents handling open wholesale and retail orders where one or more line items are flagged out of stock by the warehouse or by Shopify inventory. Out of scope: damaged or defective product issues (see SOP-CS-003), credit-only requests raised by the customer after a swap has been declined, and shipping carrier escalations that do not involve a stock substitution.

3. Overview

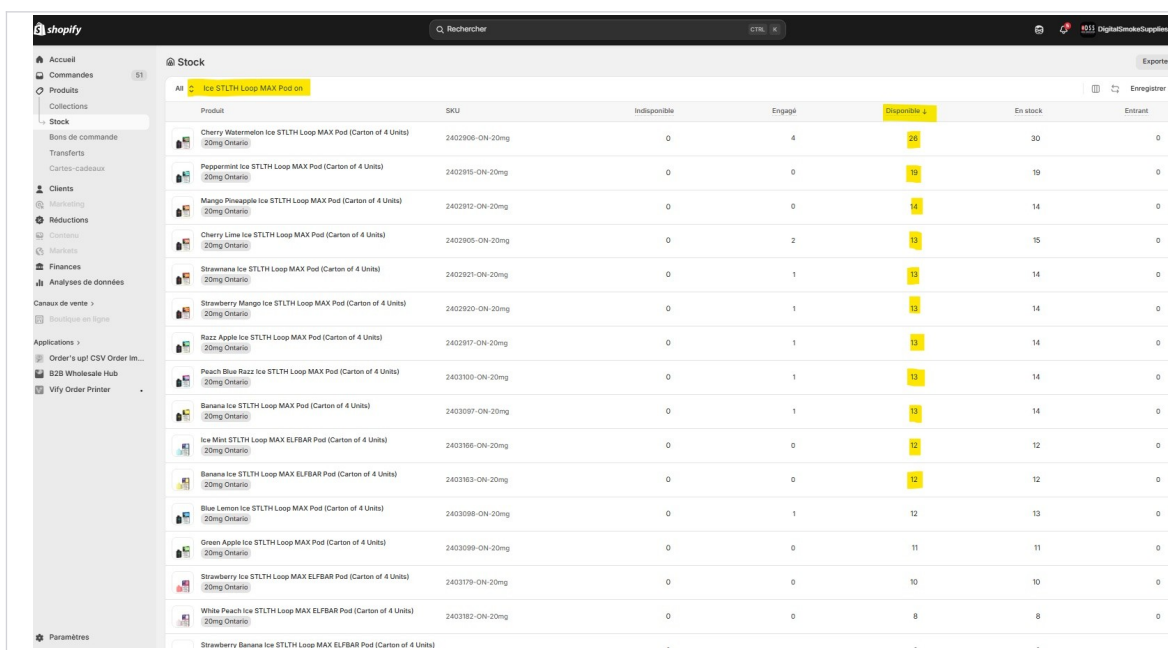
The swap flow follows a fixed order: confirm the shortfall, identify in-stock alternatives, contact the customer, capture their decision, notify the warehouse via Teams, and document the resolution in the order notes. The order in Shopify is not modified directly — the warehouse swaps the inventory item at pick time while the order record remains unchanged.

Example scenario referenced throughout this SOP: Juicy Peach Ice STLTH Loop Max Pod is out of stock on order DSS166519. The agent contacts the customer, who selects Peach Berry STLTH Loop Max Pod as the replacement. The warehouse is notified in Teams and ships the order the same day.

4. Identifying in-stock alternatives

Before contacting the customer, open Shopify Stock and filter the product family of the out-of-stock SKU (for example, STLTH Loop MAX Pod) to see what is currently available in the customer's province. Note the available quantity for each candidate replacement — customers ask, and quoting numbers shortens the call.

- Filter by product family (e.g. **Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod**) to surface comparable alternatives only.
- Filter by the customer's province so quoted stock matches the warehouse that will ship the order.
- Record at least three to five viable alternatives before reaching out — enough to give the customer real choice without overwhelming them.



Product	SKU	Indisponible	Engagé	Disponible	En stock	Entrant
Cherry Watermelon Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402806-ON-20mg	0	4	26	30	0
Peppermint Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402815-ON-20mg	0	0	19	19	0
Mango Pineapple Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402812-ON-20mg	0	0	14	14	0
Cherry Lime Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402805-ON-20mg	0	2	13	15	0
Strawberry Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402821-ON-20mg	0	1	13	14	0
Strawberry Mango Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402820-ON-20mg	0	1	13	14	0
Razz Apple Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2402817-ON-20mg	0	1	13	14	0
Peach Blue Razz Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403109-ON-20mg	0	1	13	14	0
Banana Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403097-ON-20mg	0	1	13	14	0
Ice Mint STLTH Loop MAX ELFBAR Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403106-ON-20mg	0	0	12	12	0
Banana Ice STLTH Loop MAX ELFBAR Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403103-ON-20mg	0	0	12	12	0
Blue Lemon Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403088-ON-20mg	0	1	12	13	0
Green Apple Ice STLTH Loop MAX Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403089-ON-20mg	0	0	11	11	0
Strawberry Ice STLTH Loop MAX ELFBAR Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403178-ON-20mg	0	0	10	10	0
White Peach Ice STLTH Loop MAX ELFBAR Pod (Carton of 4 Units) (20mg Ontario)	2403182-ON-20mg	0	0	8	8	0
Strawberry Banana Ice STLTH Loop MAX ELFBAR Pod (Carton of 4 Units)	-	-	-	-	-	-

Figure 1 — Shopify Stock filtered to STLTH Loop MAX Pod variants, Ontario warehouse, sorted by available quantity.

5. Contacting the customer

Reach out by the channel the customer responds to fastest. Phone works well for retail customers who manage inventory in real time, and especially well for accounts that place orders on a fixed weekly cadence (for example, Monday orders). Email is appropriate for customers who have asked to be contacted in writing or who are not reachable by phone within the same business hour.

- Check ACT for the customer's preferred contact method before choosing phone or email.
- Send the email in the customer's working language — English or French.
- Mark the email **High importance** and reference the order number (e.g. **#DSS166567**) in the subject line.

- List every viable alternative identified in step 4. State that stock will be verified once the customer chooses.
- Close with a same-day shipping ask: “Please let us know as soon as possible so we can ship your order today.”

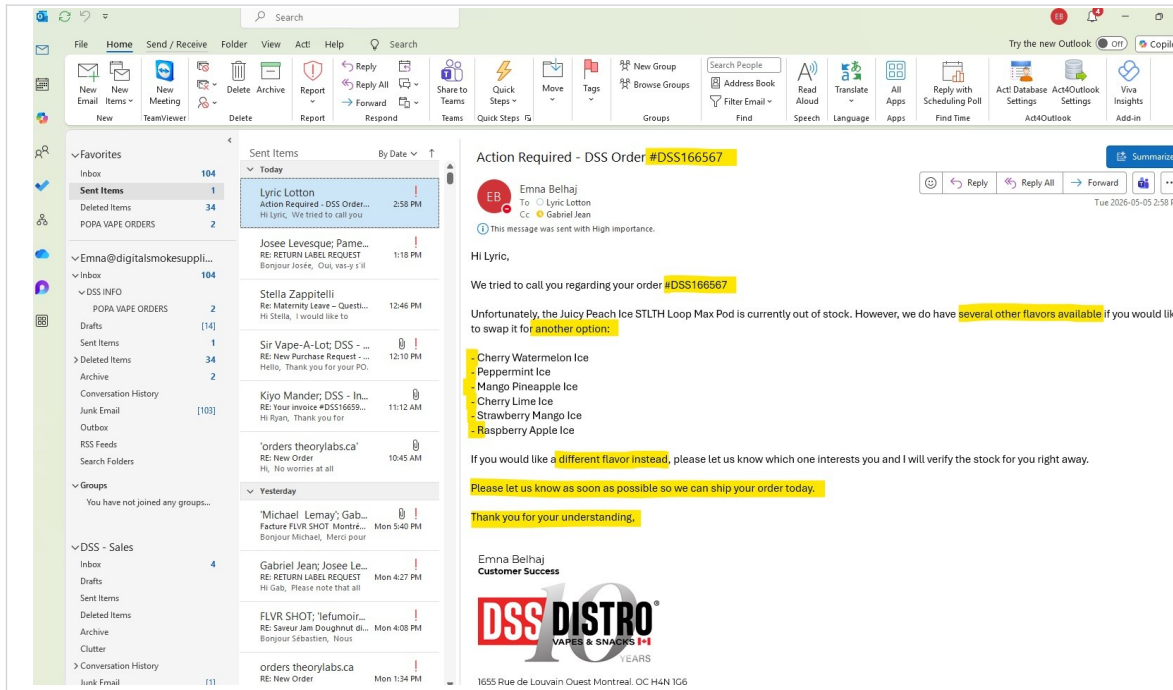


Figure 2 — English out-of-stock email referencing the order number, listing alternatives, and requesting a same-day response.

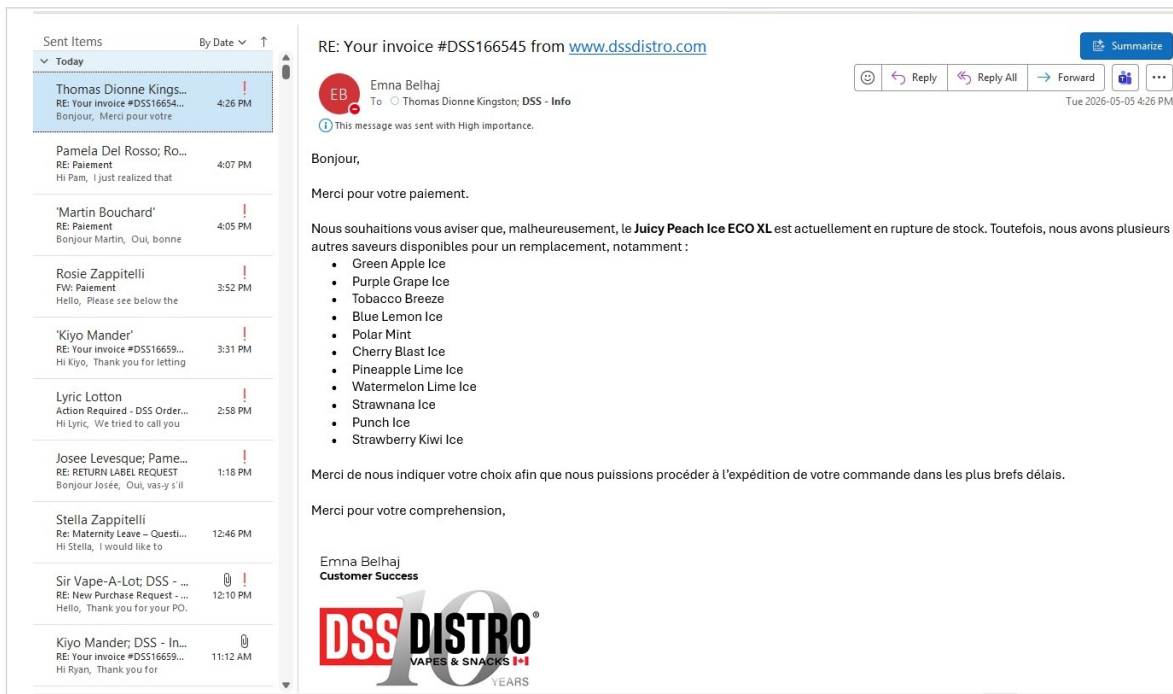


Figure 3 — French equivalent of the out-of-stock email, sent when the customer's working language is French.

6. Capturing the customer's decision

Once the customer confirms a replacement, record their choice in the order notes verbatim. If the reply arrives by email, the email thread itself is the audit trail — leave it intact and attach or reference it in the order. If the confirmation came by phone, type the customer's exact words into the order note before moving on.

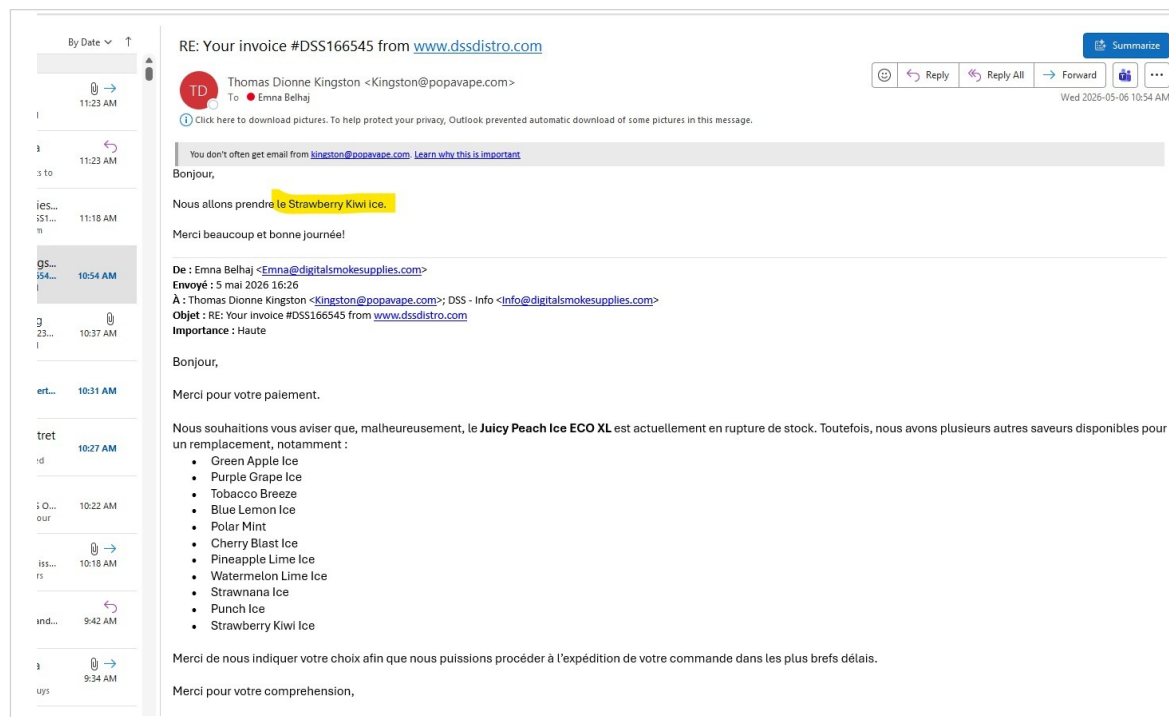


Figure 4 — Customer confirms the swap by email: “Nous allons prendre le Strawberry Kiwi ice.”

7. Notifying the warehouse

The warehouse acts only on instructions posted in the Teams “Warehouse Questions” channel — not on email, not on Shopify notes, not on verbal handoffs. Post the swap instruction the same day the customer confirms so the order ships without delay.

1. Open Teams and navigate to the **Warehouse Questions** channel.
2. Locate the existing thread for the out-of-stock SKU, or start a new post tagged with the order number and the customer name.
3. Post the swap instruction using the standard phrasing: **“Swap for <replacement product>.”**
Example: “Please swap to Peach Berry STLTH Loop MAX Pod.”
4. Wait for the warehouse acknowledgement (thumbs-up reaction or reply) before closing the thread.

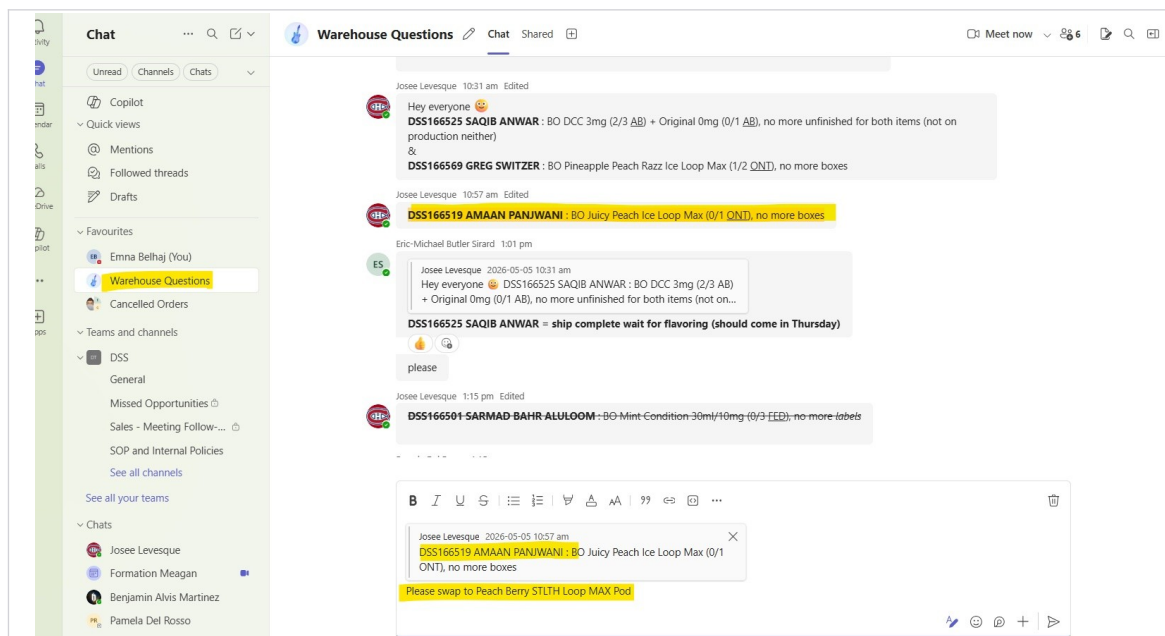


Figure 5 — Warehouse Questions channel: original SKU struck through and the replacement instruction “Please swap to Peach Berry STLTH Loop MAX Pod” posted directly underneath.

8. Shipping limitations

Express shipping is occasionally unavailable on swap days — for example, the warehouse may confirm that no 1-day shipping is available and that only 2- to 3-day options remain. When this happens, inform the customer immediately, explain that the carrier limitation is outside DSS control, and capture their acknowledgement in the order note.

Example note: “Customer advised that only 2- to 3-day shipping options were available. Customer confirmed this was acceptable.”

9. Swap-first decision rule

The initial outreach offers a replacement product only — never credit, never refund. A swap keeps the sale active, ships faster, and avoids the accounting and tracking work a credit creates. If the customer insists on credit after the swap is offered, escalate the request to the Customer Success Lead and process the credit through the standard credit workflow rather than offering it up front.

Non-Compliance

Modifying the order directly in Shopify (changing line items, swapping SKUs) causes the warehouse pick list and the order record to drift apart and creates billing reconciliation work for Finance. Offering credit instead of a swap on the first contact extends the fulfilment cycle and triggers an accounting entry that the swap would have avoided. Failing to post the swap in Warehouse Questions the same day the customer confirms delays shipment and may push the order outside the customer's expected delivery window. Repeated deviations are reviewed by the Customer Success Lead and may result in coaching, reassignment of the account, or formal performance action.

Exceptions

Credit may be offered on the first contact only when the customer has already declined every available alternative on a prior swap, or when the Customer Success Lead has pre-approved a credit-first approach for the account. The Shopify order may be modified directly only with explicit approval from the Customer Success Lead, and only after the warehouse has been notified that the original pick is cancelled. All exceptions are logged in the order note with the approver's name, the date, and the reason for the deviation.